A little guidance

The flash that wouldn't stay. · Grade 2 · Parent answer key

Three gentle sessions: 15 minutes each. Understanding matters more than finishing every line.

Math · 1

25 rods: 18 + 7 = 25. Split 7 into 2 and 5 to bridge through 20.

Math · 2

16 rods are ready to use: 25 − 9 = 16. Taking away 5 and then 4 is one way.

Math · 3

12 rods: 4 + 4 + 4 = 12. Look for three separate groups with four marks in each.

Reading · 1

Little first thought the diamond made light. The deep, dark beginning had no sunlight or lamp, and the later model showed that the bright path starts at a lamp.

Reading · 2

Light from the lamp, the diamond's cut facets, and Little's viewing position had to line up. The facets changed the light's path and sent some light toward Little's eyes.

Writing

Accept a labeled drawing, dictation, or 1–3 sentences grounded in a scene. For example: Light goes into the diamond. It changes direction and comes back out.

Wonder first; explanations can wait. These museum scenes are imagined models, not photographs. Earth layers, atom connections, ray angles, and diamond sizes are simplified. We focus on natural diamonds: carbon crystallizes under deep-Earth heat and pressure, and later eruptions can carry it upward. A diamond's age is not a stopwatch for its growth; growth histories vary. The model balls represent carbon atoms, whose strong repeating connections help explain hardness. Mohs 10 ranks scratch resistance, not toughness or a tenfold amount. Diamonds can chip or break. Bending light is refraction; bouncing light is reflection. A skilled cutter makes facets that direct light; a rough crystal need not look like a cut diamond. Some light escapes in other directions; the orange line shows just one simplified path. Keep the scientific words optional. All activities can happen with pictures, talk, and drawing. No real diamonds, scratch tests, or tools are needed. Pause whenever you have had enough.

Materials: pencil, crayons if you like, and scrap paper. Print kid pages separately from this key.